

SENATE No. 297

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

William J. Driscoll, Jr.

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to gateway municipalities.

PETITION OF:

NAME:

William J. Driscoll, Jr.

DISTRICT/ADDRESS:

Norfolk, Plymouth and Bristol

SENATE No. 297

By Mr. Driscoll, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 297) of William J. Driscoll, Jr. for legislation to define gateway municipalities. Economic Development and Emerging Technologies.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to gateway municipalities.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 23A, Section 3A is hereby amended by striking the definition of “gateway
2 municipality” and replacing it with the following definition:

3 “gateway municipality”, a municipality that satisfies three of the following criteria: (1) a
4 population of 35,000 or greater, but less than 250,000; (2) a median household income below the
5 commonwealth’s average; (3) a rate of educational attainment of a bachelor’s degree or above
6 that is below the commonwealth’s average; (4) a minority population of 40 per cent or higher,
7 and; (5) 15 percent or more of households identify as speaking English less than “very well.” The
8 secretary of economic development shall certify which municipalities qualify as a Gateway
9 municipality after each decennial census or for an individual municipality upon request by the
10 city council, selectboard, or other legislative body of a given municipality.”